Fully Funded Options in Germany, USA, Canada and the UK: Honest Assessment

Phase 8 corrections, 8 Nov 2026. E1 = official page read; E2 = official page found by search; E3 = secondary; E4 = your information

Bottom line:

- For a **September 2027 start**, none of these four countries has an open, fully funded master's scholarship whose published rules you clearly meet.
- The realistic routes are all in the **next cycle (2028 start)**:
  - **Chevening (UK)**
  - **Mastercard Foundation Scholars at ASU (USA)**: its current phase focuses on innovation and technology
  - **Fulbright (USA)**
  - **DAAD EPOS (Germany)**: only if DTU's rank letter shows the upper third
- **Partial funding in Canada** remains possible if a professor agrees to supervise you.
- **Where you study is not where the funder is.** The Mastercard Foundation is based in Toronto (Canada) but funds study in Rwanda, the USA, Canada and elsewhere. The column "Funder" keeps the two apart.
- Nothing below is invented. Where a rule is not met, it says so.

Country of study	Opportunity	Funder (where it is based)	Funding	Published rules vs you	Status for 2027	Next step	Evidence
UK	**Chevening**	UK Government (FCDO, London)	Full (tuition, stipend, flights, visa) for a 1-year master's	**≥ 2,800 hours of work after the bachelor's, gained over at least two years.** Full-time, part-time, voluntary work and paid or unpaid internships count; up to 15 periods. Your statement (3½ years) would qualify, but **0 hours are documented today**: the HR letters must prove it (`15_EMPLOYMENT_EVIDENCE/Experience_Calculation.xlsx`). Also requires an unconditional offer from a UK university that accepts 2.62/4.00, and a 2-year return home	**Closed** (2027/28 window: 4 Aug – 6 Oct 2026). **Future-cycle target**	Prepare for the **2028/29 window, expected Aug–Oct 2027**: HR letters, 3 UK course choices, essays, references	E1 (chevening.org work rule, 8 Nov 2026; GOV.UK dates)
UK	Commonwealth Scholarships	UK Government via the Commonwealth Scholarship Commission	Full	**Ethiopia is not a Commonwealth country**: not eligible	–	None	E1/E2
UK	GREAT / university awards	UK universities	Partial	Partial tuition only	–	Not recommended (not fully funded)	E3

Country of study	Opportunity	Funder (where it is based)	Funding	Published rules vs you	Status for 2027	Next step	Evidence
USA	**Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program at Arizona State University, Phase III: Innovation and Technology**	Mastercard Foundation (Toronto, Canada) via ASU	Full	The programme exists and is IT-focused (E1 Mastercard Foundation page; E2 list: **MS Information Technology**, MS Global Technology and Development). Bachelor's required. ASU graduate admission asks for 3.00 in the last 60 credit hours (E3): your years 4–5 average is **2.98** and your final year **3.20** (my calculation from the transcript), so it is **borderline: ask ASU**. One third-party site reports an age limit (E3): check it privately	**Closed for 2027/28** (deadline 27 Sep 2026, E2; your information). The Foundation's own page still says "open": it is out of date	**Monitor mcfscholars.asu.edu from June 2027** (next deadline expected about Sep 2027; assumption)	E1 / E2 / E3
USA	**Fulbright Foreign Student Program (Ethiopia)**	US Government (Department of State) via the US Embassy	Full	Run by the US Embassy in Addis (its page blocks automated access). English test and a strong academic/professional profile required	Not for 2027	Check the US Embassy Addis Fulbright announcement (usually early in the year, for study starting the following year): 2028	E2/E3
USA	University assistantships (TA/RA)	The US university	Variable	Most master's assistantships are competitive and expect a GPA ≥ 3.0	Low probability	Not recommended	E3
Canada	**Manitoba MSc (thesis)**	The university (department)	Partial: **minimum $20,000/yr** for admitted MSc students	Needs a supervisor **before applying**; your last-two-years average (2.98) is borderline	Deadline 1 Dec 2026	Only if a professor agrees now	E1
Canada	Calgary MSc (thesis)	The university	Partial (awards/assistantships)	A professor must agree to supervise; GPA is assessed	Early review 15 Jan 2027	Optional	E1
Canada	**Mastercard Foundation Scholars at UBC (Phase 2)**	Mastercard Foundation (Toronto) via UBC	Full	**Limited to forestry, agriculture, and water and land management** (E1 Foundation page). Eligible programmes are in Forestry and Land and Food Systems (E2). Young Africans with financial need who meet UBC admission. **No computer-science route**	**Closed**: expression of interest closed 6 Sep 2026 (E2)	None, unless you change field	E1 / E2
Canada	**Mastercard Foundation Scholars at McGill**	Mastercard Foundation (Toronto) via McGill	Full	**Master's in nutrition, public health, public policy and sustainable agriculture** (E1 Foundation page). Open to African citizens/residents. The information session is mandatory, and Foundation pre-screening comes before the McGill application (E2). **No computer-science route**	**Closed for Fall 2027** (McGill page via search; deadline 21 Aug 2026, E2)	None, unless you change field	E1 / E2

Country of study	Opportunity	Funder (where it is based)	Funding	Published rules vs you	Status for 2027	Next step	Evidence
Germany	**DAAD EPOS** (development-related master's)	German Government (BMZ) funds via DAAD (Bonn)	Full	"**Far above average results (upper third)**" (E2). Universities state that applicants without a ranking letter are excluded (E2). Also ≥ 2 years of related work after the bachelor's, and a degree ≤ 6 years old: **yours turns 6 on 14 Jul 2028**, so only the **Aug–Oct 2027** deadlines (2028 entry) are realistic. **2.62 alone does not show the upper third**: an indicative German grade is 3.1 ("satisfactory"). No ICT course confirmed	Next cycle only	**DTU class-rank letter first** (see `DAAD_EPOS_Upper_Third_Evidence.md`). Apply only if it shows the upper third	E2/E3
Germany	Political-foundation scholarships (e.g. Heinrich Böll, Friedrich Ebert, Konrad Adenauer)	German political foundations	Full	Usually require admission to a German university first and above-average grades	Not realistic for 2027	Revisit after admission to a tuition-free German master's	E3
Germany	Tuition-free public universities	None (self-funded)	Self-funded (blocked account ≈ living costs)	–	–	Not fully funded	E3

What would change this picture:

1. **HR letters** proving 2,800+ hours of work after graduation. This unlocks Chevening 2028/29 and supports every application.
2. A **DTU class-rank letter** showing the upper third. This opens DAAD EPOS for 2028; without it, EPOS is closed to you.
3. **ASU's next call (about Sep 2027):** confirm how ASU applies its GPA rule to your last two years.
4. A **professor's agreement** in Canada (Manitoba/Calgary, partial funding).

Sources (Phase 8):

- chevening.org/scholarships/who-can-apply/work-experience (E1, saved in `03_SCHOLARSHIP_RESEARCH/Official_Evidence_2026-11-08`)
- mastercardfdn.org institution pages for ASU, UBC and McGill (E1, 8 Nov 2026)
- mcfscholars.asu.edu, opportunity listings for ASU/UBC/McGill deadlines, and EPOS university checklists (E2, search results only; the university sites were unreachable from this session)